

Thinking About Renovating Your Bathroom?

The honest guide to bathroom renovations in Sydney: what it costs, what to expect, and how to get it right.



Before you start.

You've been thinking about this for a while.

The bathroom that felt fine five years ago now feels tired. The grout's discoloured. The layout doesn't work. Every time you walk in, you think: *this needs to go*.

But then the questions start. How much will it actually cost? How long will I be without a bathroom? How do I know if I'm getting ripped off? Where do I even start?

We hear these questions every week. And the frustrating part is, most of the information out there is either vague ("bathrooms cost \$10,000 to \$100,000") or designed to sell you something.

This guide is neither. It's what we'd tell you if you asked us over coffee. The real numbers. The decisions that actually matter. The things your builder should tell you but often doesn't.

Kate & Cam

LikeSilk Building



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01 What Bathrooms Actually Cost in Sydney

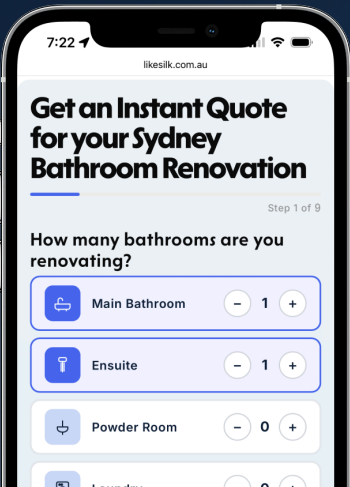
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Get Your Instant Estimate

Our free bathroom calculator gives you a realistic range in about 2 minutes, based on your bathroom size, finish level, and layout changes.

[Try the Calculator →](#)

01 What Bathrooms Actually Cost in Sydney

Real numbers based on what we see across our projects on Sydney's North Shore and surrounds in 2025–26.

Typical Price Ranges in Sydney

STANDARD

\$27k – \$35k

Same layout, new everything. Full strip-out, waterproofing, quality tiles, new tapware, vanity, toilet, and shower screen.

MID-RANGE

\$31k – \$43k

Improved layout. Better tiles and tapware, considered lighting. Double vanity, niche, underfloor heating. Designed, not just renovated.

PREMIUM

\$40k – \$55k+

Major layout changes. Premium fixtures throughout. Possibly knocking into adjacent rooms or relocating plumbing significantly.

i Powder rooms

A different category entirely: \$15,000 to \$25,000 given the smaller scope (no shower or bath).

What Drives the Price Within Each Range

Factor	Lower End	Upper End
Bathroom size	Small or ensuite	Large or combined bath/shower
Layout	Keep existing (save \$3k–\$8k)	Relocate plumbing, move walls
Fixtures	Quality pre-made vanity, standard mixer	Custom joinery, premium tapware
Tiles	Mid-range, standard format	Large format, feature walls, premium
Extras	Standard lighting and fan	Underfloor heating, niche, accent lighting
Site conditions	Modern home, clean access	Older home, asbestos, structural work

💡 TIP: MULTIPLE BATHROOMS?

Renovating two or more wet areas at the same time is significantly cheaper per room. Trades are already on site, materials are bought in bulk, and setup costs are shared. Expect to save 15–25% per additional bathroom compared to doing them separately.

Why Some Quotes Look So Much Cheaper

You'll see bathroom renovations advertised from \$15,990. That price is real, but it's not the full picture. Those quotes are typically labour-only: you source, purchase, and deliver everything else yourself. Once you add it all up, the total often lands in a similar range. The difference is you've done weeks of work the builder normally handles for you.

Bathrooms from \$15,990

Labour and installation only. You supply:

- Tiles
- Vanity
- Tapware and mixers
- Toilet
- Shower screen
- Accessories and lighting

Bathrooms from \$25,000+

Fixed price, fully managed. Includes:

- All fixtures and fittings
- Demolition and waste removal
- Waterproofing and certification
- All trades coordinated
- Project management
- Site protection and clean-up

The "Cosmetic Refresh" Myth

Many homeowners think they can just change the tiles and tapware to save money. Here's the reality:

i Once you remove tiles, the waterproofing membrane is compromised.

NSW building codes require full waterproofing replacement before new tiles go down. There's no partial fix. This is the main reason a "quick tile swap" doesn't exist.

Task	Cosmetic	Full Reno
Painting walls or ceilings	✓	
Replacing surface-mounted tapware	✓	
New mirror or vanity cabinet	✓	
New toilet seat	✓	
Accessories (towel rails, hooks)	✓	
Replacing tiles (floor or wall)		✓
Changing shower layout or fixtures		✓
Moving plumbing fixtures		✓
Fixing leaks or water damage		✓

02 The Decisions You'll Need to Make

More decisions than you'd expect, but they follow a logical order. Make them in the right sequence and each one gets easier.

1. Layout

Before you fall in love with tiles or tapware, figure out whether your layout works.

The golden rules

- **Toilet:** Minimum 900mm clear space in front, 200mm from walls on each side
- **Door swing:** Should never hit the toilet or vanity
- **Shower:** 900mm x 900mm minimum. 1000mm x 1200mm is noticeably more comfortable
- **Traffic flow:** Clear path from door to shower without bumping into anything

💡 TIP: LAYOUT MATTERS

A good builder will confirm the layout and all clearances before any work begins, making sure every fixture fits properly and the space works in practice, not just on paper.

2. Tiles

	What actually matters	What's just preference
Safety	Slip rating P3 minimum for wet areas	Colour, pattern, texture
Performance	Low porosity (low water absorption)	Feature walls vs full coverage
Format	Large format needs perfectly flat surfaces	Accent walls make expensive tiles affordable

Common tile layouts



💡 TIP: THE SMART APPROACH

Mid-range tiles installed beautifully look better than expensive tiles installed poorly. Save \$2,000–\$5,000 on tiles without anyone noticing, provided the installation is excellent.

3. Tapware

The most-used fixture in your bathroom. You'll touch your tapware more than any other element, every single day for the next 10–15 years. This is where quality really counts.

We recommend brands like [ABI Interiors](#) and [Brodware](#) that offer long warranties, quality internals, and finishes that last. Cheap tapware might look the same in photos, but the difference shows up quickly in daily use.

Colour options

Most quality brands offer a full range of finishes, so you can match your tapware to your style without compromising on quality:



Stainless Steel



Matte Black



Brushed Nickel



Brushed Gunmetal



Brushed Brass



Brushed Copper

4. Vanity

The vanity is often the visual centrepiece of the bathroom. Get this right and everything else falls into place around it.

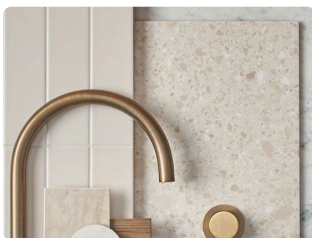
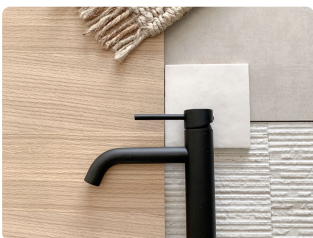
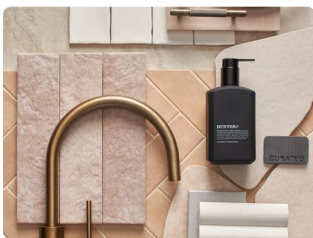
Wall-hung

- Clean, modern look
- Easy to clean the floor underneath
- Makes small bathrooms feel bigger
- Requires solid wall framing

Freestanding

- Works with any wall type
- More storage from floor to bench
- Easier to install and replace
- Traditional or modern styles

Basin style	Best for
Undermount	Seamless benchtop. Easy to wipe water straight into the basin.
Above-counter	Design statement. Adds height. Wide range of shapes and materials.
Semi-recessed	Sits partly in, partly over the benchtop. Great for narrow vanities.
Integrated	Basin and benchtop in one piece. No joins, no gaps, easy to clean.



5. Shower

The shower is the centrepiece of the room. Most clients go with a **rain shower + hand-held on a rail** — rain for daily use, hand-held for kids, pets, and cleaning. A diverter lets you switch between both from one control: fewer holes in the wall, cleaner look. Quality internals matter — cheap mixers fail within a few years.

Shower niches

Much cleaner than corner shelves. Size them for real life: a 300 × 600mm niche fits actual shampoo bottles. The narrow 150mm versions look great in photos but fit nothing useful. Niches must be planned before waterproofing.



Full-width niche with LED



Rectangle shower niche

Shower screens

Frameless glass is the most popular choice. Standard sizes save 30-50% compared to custom. Semi-frameless is a good middle ground if budget is tight. All glass should be certified to AS/NZS 2208.



Frameless shower screen



Semi-frameless shower screen

6. Toilet

A quality toilet lasts 15-20 years. We recommend rimless designs (much easier to clean) with a good WELS water rating. Our go-to is [Caroma](#) — Australian-made, excellent flush performance, and parts are always available locally. Their Cleanflush technology eliminates the rim entirely, which makes a real difference long-term.



Back-to-wall

Cistern hidden in the wall. Clean, streamlined look. Easiest to clean around.



Close-coupled

Traditional style. Cistern sits on top. Simple to install and maintain.



Wall-hung

Floats off the floor. Most premium look. Requires in-wall frame.

7. Lighting and Ventilation

Two things that get treated as afterthoughts but make an enormous difference to how your bathroom looks and lasts.

Lighting

Good bathroom lighting has three layers:

- **Overhead:** LED downlights for general light
- **Task:** Backlit mirror or sconces at face height
- **Accent:** Niche or under-vanity LEDs

Ventilation

Sydney's humidity means mould without proper airflow.

- Fan must vent **outside**, not into the ceiling
- Timer or humidity sensor switch
- Sized correctly for the room

💡 TIP: WARM WHITE, NOT COOL WHITE

Choose 3000K (warm white) for a relaxing feel. Avoid 5000K (cool white) which looks clinical. This one detail completely changes the mood of the room.

03 Where to Spend and Where to Save

Not every dollar has the same impact. Here's where we see the biggest difference.

Worth spending on

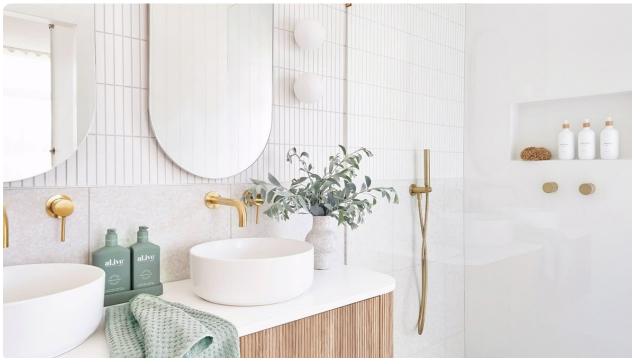
- **Waterproofing:** non-negotiable. Cutting corners here risks serious damage down the line
- **Shower mixer:** you use this daily for years. Quality internals matter
- **Basin mixer taps:** ceramic disc cartridges, quality finishes
- **Ventilation:** prevention is far cheaper than the cure
- **Toilet:** lasts 15-20 years. Worth investing in a good one

Easy saves

- **Tiles:** mid-range tiles + great tiler beats expensive tiles + average tiler
- **Vanity:** quality pre-made units look just as good as custom joinery
- **Shower screen:** standard sizes look just as good as custom and cost significantly less
- **Mirror:** a fixed mirror instead of a shaving cabinet saves budget without losing style

⚠ The hidden cost of cheap

A quality mixer that lasts 10+ years is cheaper than replacing a budget one every two years, plus a plumber's call-out each time. Low-quality toilets develop leaks that waste water. Failed waterproofing behind tiles is invisible until the damage is serious. Buy once, buy right.



04 What to Actually Expect

The honest version: planning, construction, and what makes it manageable.

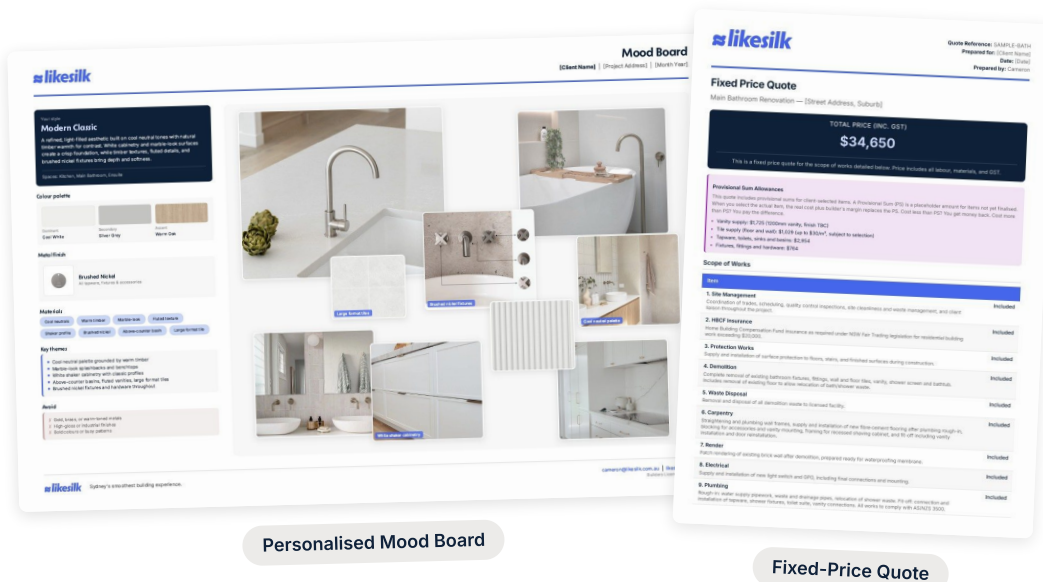
The Timeline

A standard bathroom renovation takes around 4-5 weeks from planning to handover.

- 0 Planning and selections: 1-3 weeks**
 Layout, tiles, tapware, vanity, lighting, electrical: all locked in before anything gets demolished. This phase is why the build phase runs smoothly.
- 1 Week 1: Demolition and rough-in**
 Strip-out of existing bathroom. New plumbing and electrical rough-in. Any structural work.
- 2 Week 2: Waterproofing and tiling**
 Waterproofing membrane applied, dried, and inspected. Floor tiling begins, then walls. Waterproofing needs proper curing time.
- 3 Week 3: Fixtures and fit-off**
 Vanity installed. Shower screen fitted. Plumbing fixtures connected: taps, shower, toilet.
- 4 Week 4: Finishing and handover**
 Final electrical, accessories, silicone, clean-up, inspection, and handover.

During the Planning Phase

We send you a design questionnaire to understand your style, build a mood board with your selections, guide you through tiles, tapware, and finishes, then deliver a detailed fixed-price quote — all before a single tile is removed.



Personalised Mood Board

Fixed-Price Quote

Living Through a Renovation

You'll be without that bathroom for 3-4 weeks. If it's your only bathroom, you'll need a plan before demolition day.

Before you start

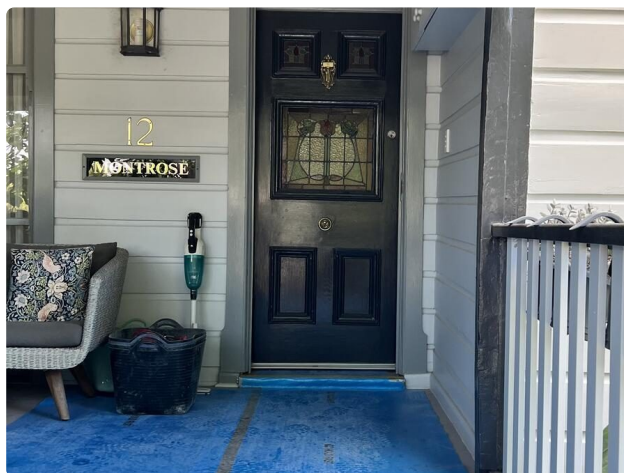
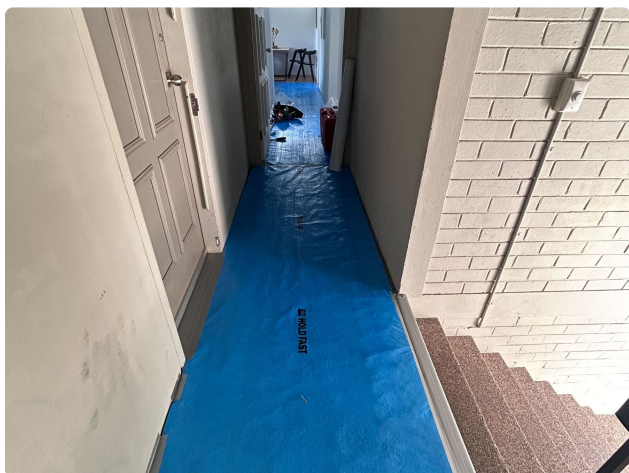
- Arrange access to another bathroom (ensuite, kids' bathroom, neighbour, or gym)
- Set expectations with your household on timeline and noise
- Clear out all personal items, towels, and products
- Ask your builder about a portable bathroom if needed

During the build

- Expect noise during work hours and some dust (even with containment)
- Trades will need access through your home
- Your builder should communicate daily on progress
- Most disruption is in week 1 (demolition), then it settles

Site Protection

A good builder treats your home with respect. That means proper containment around the work zone, floor protection through walkways, dust barriers, and a clean-up at the end of every day. You shouldn't have to live in a construction site.



TIP: ASK UPFRONT

Ask your builder what their site protection process looks like before you sign. Floor coverings, dust sheets, zip walls, daily clean-up. It tells you a lot about how they'll treat your home.

05 How to Choose the Right Builder

Your builder choice determines the entire experience. The right one makes it smooth. The wrong one makes it a nightmare.

The best builders don't just build well. They communicate, they plan, and they make the whole process feel easy. Here's what separates the professionals from the rest.

What a good builder looks like

Area	What to expect
Communication	Fast, clear responses from the first enquiry. If they're slow now, they'll be invisible during the build.
Process	A structured approach: selections first, then planning, then build. Not making it up as they go.
Quoting	Detailed, transparent, fixed pricing. You should know exactly what's included and what isn't.
Experience	Bathroom-specific work: waterproofing, plumbing compliance, ventilation. Not just general building.
Licensing	Licensed and insured. HBCF insurance for work over \$20K. Verifiable on Service NSW.

Red flags

Be cautious if they...

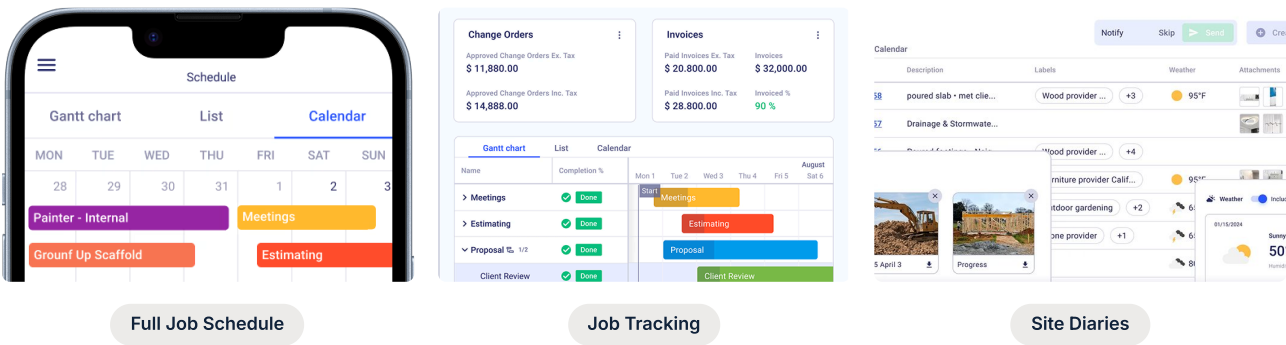
- Can start immediately (no planning phase)
- Are vague about waterproofing process
- Quote is dramatically cheaper than others

Walk away if they...

- Won't provide a detailed, fixed-price quote
- Can't show recent bathroom projects
- Are hard to get hold of before the job starts

What it's like working with LikeSilk

You get full visibility of your project through our building software — live job schedule, progress tracking, and daily site diaries. You'll always know exactly where things are at without having to chase.



06 Ready to Get Started?

You don't need to become a renovation expert. You just need to know what you want, and find the right builder to handle the rest.

Know what you want

- ☐ Have a budget range in mind
- ☐ Save some inspiration images you like
- ☐ Know what bothers you about your current bathroom

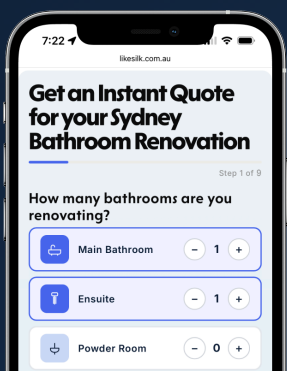
Get a realistic estimate

- ☐ Use our bathroom calculator for an indicative range
- ☐ Understand what's included in a proper renovation quote

Find the right builder

- ☐ Licensed, insured, and experienced with bathrooms
- ☐ Clear quote with scope, timeline, and fixed pricing
- ☐ Strong communication from the very first conversation
- ☐ A proper process: selections, planning, then build

The right builder makes this easy. They guide you through selections, handle the coordination, and keep you informed without you having to chase.



Start with a quick estimate

Our bathroom calculator gives you a realistic range based on your specific bathroom. Takes just 2 minutes.

[Get Your Estimate →](#)

Next Steps

1 Reach Out Get in touch to tell us about your bathroom and what you're looking to achieve.	2 Site Inspection We visit your property to assess the existing bathroom and discuss your vision.	3 Detailed Quote We provide a fixed-price quote with a full scope of works, timeline, and inclusions.	4 Get Started Accept the quote, complete selections, and we bring your new bathroom to life.
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[Book a Free Planning Call](#)
[Try the Bathroom Calculator](#)

Want to chat through the options? Give Cameron a call to talk through your next move.

0434 926 207 | cameron@likesilk.com.au

About LikeSilk

LikeSilk is a family-run building company on Sydney's North Shore. We specialise in bathroom renovations, kitchen renovations, and full home transformations.

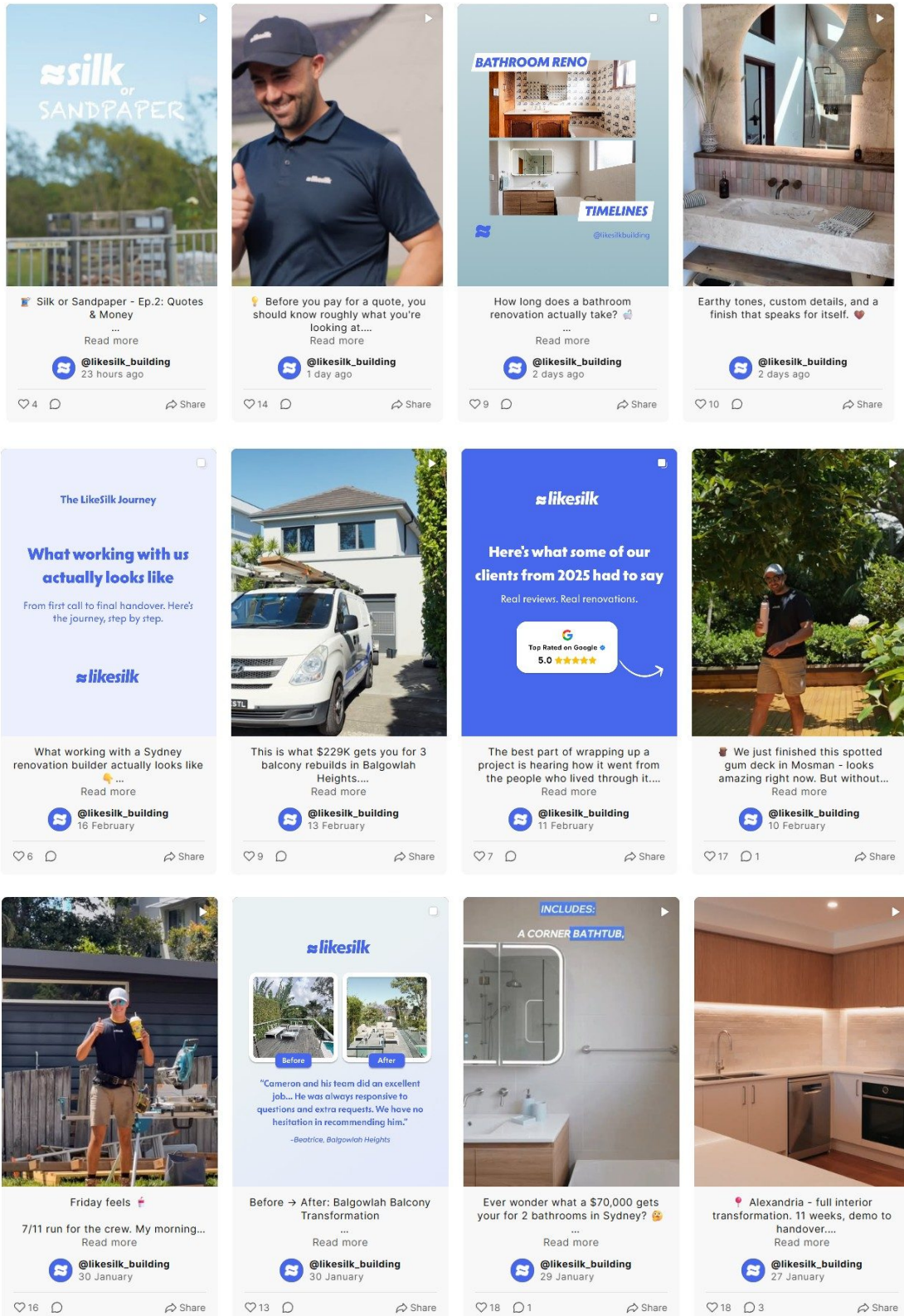
Founded by Cam (licensed builder with experience across every role in construction) and Kate (product strategist obsessed with making things easy), we built LikeSilk around one idea: renovation should be organised, transparent, and genuinely smooth for the client.

Fixed pricing. Clear communication. A proper process from start to finish.



See what we've been up to

Check out our Instagram





Sydney's smoothest building experience.

likesilk.com.au